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Flooring edge tools

Abstract

A hand-held or table-mounted tool for adhering a flooring edge finish to a flooring edge. The hand-held tool includes a main body, which can include a handle, a base, and a bi-level soleplate, which is heated during application to adhere a flooring edge finish to a flooring edge. The soleplate of the tool can be made of polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a divisional application, which claims priority to pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/320,777 filed on May 14, 2021, which claims the benefit of priority U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/025,675, filed on May 15, 2020. The entire contents of the above-referenced patent applications are incorporated by reference in their entirety herein.

BACKGROUND

(1) Carpeting and hard surface flooring can function as beautiful additions to any home or business. The durability and esthetics of the finishing of many of these products need improvement, however. Generally, carpets that are not fitted to a wall have an exposed edge that should be bound to prevent fraying of the carpet fibers and to prevent damage to the carpet backing underneath. Similarly, hard surface flooring can have a ragged and uneven edge, which can be damaged with wear.

(2) Current methods of finishing flooring edges are ineffectual, often resulting in unattractive products. One method of preventing flooring edge fraying involves stapling the raw edge of the flooring with large metal staples, which is both unsightly and hazardous, as the staples inevitably detach with wear. Another method involves stitching the end of a carpet with heavy yarn, which stitching is inelegant and unravels with time. Furthermore, stitching requires expensive, heavy-duty sewing machines. Still another method pertains to gluing the edge of the flooring, which application and outcome is messy and displeasing to the eye. In addition, these methods can be troublesome because bulky, heavy equipment must be used for the installation and flooring edge finishing. Thus, there exists a need for a compact, easy-to-use, hand-held tool for finishing the edge of a carpet or hard surface flooring at an installation site and for an in-line system for finishing an edge in a factory setting, which the present disclosure provides.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(3) The present application is directed to a hand-held or table-mounted flooring edge tool for applying a flooring edge finish, which provides the look of a factory or custom finish to the edge of a carpet or a hard surface flooring. Upon installation, the raw edge of the flooring is securely and discreetly hidden by the flooring edge finish. The flooring edge finish includes a longitudinal section coated with an adhesive and a hinge. The flooring edge tool is structured so as to be able to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof, to the bottom and side sections of the flooring edge finish simultaneously.

(4) The flooring edge tool for applying a flooring edge finish to a flooring surface includes a main body having a handle for grasping that includes a base having a first width $W_{sub.1}$; a bi-level soleplate coplanar with and coupled to the base, the bi-level soleplate comprising at least two sections, wherein a first section of the soleplate has a first thickness $T_{sub.1}$, a length L , and a second width $W_{sub.2}$; and a second section of the soleplate has a second thickness $T_{sub.2}$, the length L , and a third width $W_{sub.3}$, wherein $T_{sub.2}$ is greater than $T_{sub.1}$, and $W_{sub.3}$ is approximately equal to $W_{sub.1} - W_{sub.2}$; and a heating element within the main body for heating the bi-level soleplate.

(5) Another embodiment is directed to a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a flooring edge tool, which includes positioning a flooring edge finish at the edge of a flooring; and applying heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish using the flooring edge tool having a bi-level soleplate, wherein the flooring edge finish is adhered to a bottom surface of the flooring and an edge of the flooring simultaneously.

(6) Yet another embodiment is a heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising a feed section including a first lower plate having a length and width; an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section, such that a first longitudinal

section of the finishing strip is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and an attachment section abutting the feed section comprising a second lower plate; a second edge plate; and one or more heating elements for heating the second lower plate and the second edge plate to adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and edge surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

(7) Still another embodiment pertains to a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a table-mounted flooring edge tool comprising a feed section and an attachment section, the method comprising feeding a flooring edge finish into the feed section so that the flooring edge finish contacts the edge, bottom, or both edge and bottom of the flooring; feeding the flooring along the feed section so that a bottom and side of the flooring is adjacent to the flooring edge finish when leaving the feed section and entering the attachment section; and applying heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish using a heating element coupled to the attachment section, wherein the flooring edge finish is adhered to a bottom surface of the flooring and an edge of the flooring simultaneously.

(8) The flooring edge finishing tool of this application has several benefits and advantages. One benefit is that the hand-held tool provides an uncomplicated and efficient method of on-site flooring edge finishing. A second benefit is that the hand-held tool is lightweight and compact making it easy to handle and to transport. A third benefit is the ability to simultaneously adhere a finishing strip to two surfaces (bottom and side) of a flooring edge with the unique biplanar soleplate. A fourth benefit is that the heating table can finish the flooring edge with a flooring edge finish as an in-line automated process.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a portion of a carpet and a flooring edge finish before adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a side view of a portion of the carpet and flooring edge finish after adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.
- (3) FIG. 3 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool.
- (4) FIG. 4 is an end view of an alternative hand-held flooring edge tool.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a photograph illustrating the hand-held flooring tool of FIG. 3 as it is used to apply a flooring edge finish to a carpet.
- (6) FIG. 6 is an end view of another hand-held flooring edge tool.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a hand-held flooring edge tool.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a photograph of a heat gun for use in applying a flooring edge finish to a flooring.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a photograph of a heat gun in use.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a flowchart illustrating a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a table-mounted flooring edge tool.
- (14) FIG. 14 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool adjacent to a carpet and flooring edge finish after adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

- (15) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of an unbound assembly 10 of a carpet 12 and a flooring edge finish 14. Carpet 12 is depicted as a representative flooring; however, any type of flooring can be

used, including a carpet, a hard surface flooring, a luxury vinyl tile, a resilient vinyl flooring, a laminate flooring, or a mixture thereof. Carpet **12** has fibers **26** embedded into carpet backing **24**. Carpet pad **16**, which is optional, can be included underneath carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** includes a longitudinal section **20** including a hinge **22**. The longitudinal section **20** has an adhesive **18** on a top surface. Hinge **22** has a gap or an absence of the adhesive. Flooring edge finish **14** is upwardly foldable along the hinge **22** to bind, protect, and conceal an edge of a flooring as shown in FIG. 2. Although flooring edge finish **14** is shown in contact with pad **16**, this is for purposes of illustrating a positioning of flooring edge finish **14** and does not indicate that the flooring edge finish has been partially adhered to carpet **12**.

(16) FIG. 2 shows a side view **15** of carpet **12** and flooring edge finish **14** after flooring edge finish **14** has been adhered to a carpet **12**. As in FIG. 1, carpet **12** has fibers **26** embedded into carpet backing **24** and an optional carpet pad **16** underneath the carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** has been folded upward approximately 90 degrees along the hinge **22** so that the adhesive **18** on longitudinal section **20** contacts carpet pad **16** and carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** binds and covers the carpet **12** bottom surface and edge.

(17) In one embodiment, hinge **22** can include an approximately 90-degree bend in the flooring edge finish **14** along a bottom section of the edge of the flooring after binding of the longitudinal section **20** to an edge of the flooring. Hinge **22** can also comprise a bend of about 20-170 degrees after binding to the flooring edge. Hinge **22** can also comprise multiple hinges or multiple gaps having little or no adhesive. Further, hinge **22** can form an arcuate bend.

(18) Application of flooring edge finish **14** can be accomplished by heating longitudinal section **20** containing the adhesive **18** with flooring edge tool. The tool can be hand-held, or table-mounted. In one embodiment, the hand-held tool is used to heat the flooring edge finish **14** with pressure against the flooring to provide adherence of the flooring edge finish. In a continuous process where the flooring edge tool is table-mounted, the flooring edge finish **14** can be fed parallel to the flooring, which would properly position the longitudinal section **20** of the flooring edge finish alongside the bottom and side edges of the flooring. Once positioned, flooring edge finish **14** could be heated while traveling with the flooring through the machinery of the continuous process.

(19) FIG. 3 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. A main body **32** of the tool includes an upper extension **34**, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body **32** also includes a base **36** having a first width $W_{sub.1}$ of about 0.2-12 inches, and a length L of about 4-12 inches. In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base **36**. A bi-level soleplate **38** is co-planar with and coupled to base **36**. Bi-level soleplate **38** includes a first section **40** having a first thickness $T_{sub.1}$ of about 0.1-1 inches, length L , and a second width $W_{sub.2}$ of about 0.1-6 inches, wherein the second width $W_{sub.2}$ is less than the first width $W_{sub.1}$. The second section of the soleplate **42** has a second thickness $T_{sub.2}$ of about 0.2-6 inches, length L and a third width $W_{sub.3}$ of about 0.1-6 inches, wherein $T_{sub.2}$ is greater than $T_{sub.1}$ and $W_{sub.3}$ is approximately equal to $W_{sub.1} - W_{sub.2}$. First section **40** and second section **42** meet to form an angle $A_{sub.1}$. In embodiments, angle $A_{sub.1}$ is approximately 65-85 degrees. In another embodiment, angle $A_{sub.1}$ is approximately 90 degrees.

(20) One or more heating elements **44** are incorporated in main body **32** of the hand-held flooring edge tool in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate **38** for adhering a flooring edge finish **14** to flooring. Main body **32** also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements **44** and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base **36** and bi-level soleplate **38**, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements **44** are embedded within the base **36** and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate **38**. The second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F. The flooring edge tool can adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and the edge of the flooring simultaneously.

(21) FIG. 4 is an end view of hand-held flooring edge tool **30A**. In embodiments, flooring edge tool **30A** is generally the same as tool **30** in FIG. 3, except that angle A.sub.2 between first section **40** and second section **42** is less than 90 degrees. In embodiments, angle A.sub.2 can be between approximately 65 and 85 degrees. Angle A.sub.2 can be used in flooring edge tool **30A** to cause flooring edge finish **14** to be more firmly attached to the flooring.

(22) FIG. 5 is a photograph illustrating an end view of hand-held flooring tool **30**, as it is used to apply a flooring edge finish **14** to a carpet **12**. Carpet **12** is placed upside down while flooring edge finish **14** is adhered to the bottom and side of carpet **12** simultaneously.

(23) FIG. 6 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool **50**. A main body **52** includes an upper extension **54**, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body **52** of the tool also includes a base **56** having a width W.sub.1 and a length L (not shown). In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base **56**. Width W.sub.1 includes base **56** as well as base projection **58**, which extends downward from base **56** to a thickness approximately equal to T.sub.2. Base projection **58** extends downward from base **56** along the entire length L of base **56**.

(24) A bi-level soleplate **60** is coupled to base **56** and base projection **58**. Bi-level soleplate **60** includes a first section **62** having a first thickness T.sub.1, length L and a second width W.sub.2, wherein the second width W.sub.2 is less than the first width W.sub.1 and a second section **64** having a second thickness T.sub.2, length L and a third width W.sub.3, wherein T.sub.2 is greater than T.sub.1 and W.sub.3 is approximately equal to W.sub.1-W.sub.2. In another embodiment, the second width W.sub.2 is greater than, less than, or equal to the third width W.sub.3. First section **62** and second section **64** form an angle A.sub.1. In embodiments, angle A.sub.1 is approximately 90 degrees, but can be any angle between approximately 65 and 85 degrees. In another embodiment, a total width of the bi-level soleplate (W.sub.2+W.sub.3) is less than the width of the base (W.sub.1). The soleplate can be made of polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.

(25) Heating elements **66** are incorporated in main body **52** in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate **60** for heating a flooring edge finish **14** to flooring. Main body **52** also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements **66** and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base **56** and bi-level soleplate **60** of the tool, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements **66** are embedded within the base **56** and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate **60**. The heating elements **66** can be spread out randomly or uniformly within the main body **52**.

(26) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method **70** of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using the edge finishing tool of FIG. 3, 4 or 6. In embodiments, method **70** includes at least one of steps **72**, **74** and **76**.

(27) Step **72** includes positioning a flooring edge finish **14** of FIG. 1 along an edge of a flooring. In an example of step **72**, flooring edge finish has a longitudinal section including a hinge and the longitudinal section is positioned along a bottom surface of the flooring and along a side of the flooring.

(28) Step **74** includes using a flooring edge tool to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In an example of step **74**, a bi-level soleplate **38** of flooring edge tool **30** is positioned against the longitudinal section to simultaneously adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and edge surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

(29) Step **76**, which is optional, includes using a heat gun or other external heat source to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish so as to melt the adhesive and adhere to the flooring surfaces. In an example of step **76**, a heat gun **78** as shown in FIG. 8 includes a pressure plate **80**. As shown in FIG. 9, heat gun **78** optionally can be applied to longitudinal section **20** of flooring edge finish **14** in the direction of arrow **82** to heat longitudinal section **20**, then apply pressure using pressure plate **80**.

(30) Yet another embodiment is a heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to

flooring, said table comprising a feed section including a first lower plate having a length and width; an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section such that a first longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and an attachment section abutting the feed section comprising a second lower plate; a second edge plate; and one or more heating elements for heating the second lower plate and the second edge plate to adhere the flooring edge finish to bottom and edge surfaces of flooring simultaneously. The second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof. The first edge plate has a shorter length than the first lower plate.

(31) FIGS. **10-12** are photographs of different perspectives of a table mounted flooring edge tool. In embodiments, the table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** includes a feed section **102** and an attachment section **104**. Feed section **102** includes a lower plate **106**, an upper plate **108** and an edge plate **110**. One longitudinal section of flooring edge finish **14** is sandwiched between lower plate **106** and the upper plate **108** while another longitudinal section is sandwiched between upper plate **108** and edge plate **110**. In embodiments, upper plate **108** can have the same length as lower plate **106**, or upper plate **108** can be shorter than lower plate **106** to assist movement of flooring edge finish **14** from feed section **102** to attachment section **104**. The configuration of lower plate **106**, upper plate **108** and edge plate **110** serves to bend flooring edge finish **14** along hinge **22**. Flooring edge finish **14** enters one end of feed section **102** as shown in FIG. **11**, and exits the other end of feed section **102** as shown in FIG. **10** in preparation for being applied to a flooring.

(32) In embodiments, table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** includes an attachment section **104**. Attachment section **104** generally abuts feed section **102** so that flooring can move smoothly in the process. In embodiments, attachment section **104** and feed section **102** are separated by a gap. Attachment section **104** includes a lower plate **112** and an edge plate **114**. Lower plate **112** is generally co-planar with upper plate **108**. Edge plate **114** is generally coplanar with edge plate **110**. In embodiments, edge plate **114** can be thicker than edge plate **110** to accommodate the combined thickness of flooring edge finish **14** and flooring.

(33) Attachment section **104** includes one or more heating elements **116**, which can be used to heat lower plate **112** and edge plate **114** while applying flooring edge finish **14** to a flooring (not shown). Lower plate **112** and edge plate **114** can be fabricated of suitable rigid conductors of heat including, but not limited to, polymer, carbon, metal ceramic, glass, or mixtures thereof. The metal can be aluminum, copper, brass, steel, or bronze. The heat conductors are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F. The heating temperature can vary or can be constant. In embodiments, edge plate **114** can form an angle of approximately 90 degrees with lower plate **112**. In other embodiments, edge plate **114** can form an angle between approximately 65 and 85 degrees with lower plate **112**.

(34) In embodiments, table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** can include a support section **120** for supporting a flooring while flooring edge finish **14** is being applied. In embodiments, edge plates **110** and **114** can have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch. In embodiments, feed section **102** and attachment section **104** can have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.

(35) FIG. **13** is a flowchart illustrating a method **130** of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using the table-mounted flooring edge tool of FIGS. **10-12**. In embodiments, method **130** includes at least one of steps **132**, **134**, **136** and **138**, described below.

(36) FIG. **14** shows a view of the hand-held flooring tool **30** adjacent to an applied finishing strip **14** on an edge of a carpet **12**. Shown is a side view **15** of carpet **12** and flooring edge finish **14** after

flooring edge finish **14** has been adhered to a carpet **12**. As in FIG. **1**, carpet **12** has fibers **26** embedded into carpet backing **24** and an optional carpet pad **16** underneath the carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** has been folded upward approximately 90 degrees along the hinge **22** so that the adhesive **18** on longitudinal section **20** contacts carpet pad **16** and carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** binds and covers the carpet **12**.

(37) Also shown is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. A main body **32** includes an upper extension **34**, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body **32** also includes a base **36** having a width $W_{sub.1}$ and a length L (not shown). In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base **36**. A bi-level soleplate **38** is co-planar with and coupled to base **36**. Bi-level soleplate **38** includes a first section **40** having a first thickness $T_{sub.1}$, length L and a second width $W_{sub.2}$, wherein the second width $W_{sub.2}$ is less than the first width $W_{sub.1}$. The bi-level soleplate includes a second section **42** having a second thickness $T_{sub.2}$, length L and a third width $W_{sub.3}$, wherein $T_{sub.2}$ is greater than $T_{sub.1}$ and $W_{sub.3}$ is approximately equal to $W_{sub.1} - W_{sub.2}$. In another embodiment, the length L is greater than or equal to the width of the base $W_{sub.1}$. First section **40** and second section **42** form an angle $A_{sub.1}$. In embodiments, angle $A_{sub.1}$ is approximately 65-95 degrees or, in another embodiment, about 90 degrees.

(38) One or more heating elements **44** are incorporated in main body **32** in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate **38** for heating during application of a flooring edge finish **14** to flooring. Main body **32** also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements **44** and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base **36** and bi-level soleplate **38**, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements **44** are embedded within the base **36** and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate **38**. The heating elements can be randomly or uniformly positioned.

(39) Step **132** includes feeding a flooring edge finish **14** of FIG. **1** into feed section **102**. In an example of step **132**, flooring edge finish includes a longitudinal section including a hinge where the longitudinal section is placed along a bottom surface of the flooring and the other longitudinal section is placed along a side of the flooring. One longitudinal section is fed between lower plate **106** and upper plate **108** while the other longitudinal section is fed between upper plate **108** and edge plate **110**.

(40) Step **134** includes feeding a flooring along feed section **102**. In an example of step **134**, flooring travels along feed section **102** at the same rate that flooring edge finish **14** so that a leading edge of the flooring and flooring edge finish **14** meet as they leave feed section **102** and enter attachment section **104**. Feed section **102** causes flooring edge finish **14** to be positioned along a bottom and edge of the flooring so that the flooring edge finish can be adhered to the flooring in attachment section **104**.

(41) Step **136** includes using attachment section **104** to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In an example of step **136**, attachment section **104** is placed against both longitudinal sections simultaneously to adhere flooring edge finish **14** to the bottom and side surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

(42) Step **138**, which is optional, includes using a heat gun to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In embodiments, step **138** is similar to step **76** of FIG. **7**.

(43) Alternative embodiments of the subject matter of this application will become apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art to which the present invention pertains, without departing from its spirit and scope. It is to be understood that no limitation with respect to specific embodiments shown here is intended or inferred.

Claims

1. A heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising: (a) a feed section comprising: (i) a first lower plate having a length and width; (ii) an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and (iii) a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section, such that a first longitudinal section of the flooring edge finish is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the flooring edge finish is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and (b) an attachment section abutting the feed section, comprising: (i) a second lower plate; (ii) a second edge plate; and (iii) one or more heating elements for heating the second lower plate and the second edge plate to apply the flooring edge finish to a bottom surface and an edge surface of the flooring.
2. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the first edge plate has a shorter length than the first lower plate.
3. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.
4. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F.
5. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.
6. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the first and second edge plates have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch.
7. The heating table of claim 1, further comprising a support section.
8. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the heating table is capable of finishing the flooring edge with a flooring edge finish as an in-line automated process.
9. A heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising: (a) a feed section comprising: (i) a first lower plate having a length and width; (ii) an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and (iii) a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; and (b) an attachment section comprising: (i) a second lower plate; (ii) a second edge plate; and (iii) one or more heating elements; wherein the feed section and the attachment section are separated by a gap.
10. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.
11. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F.
12. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.
13. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and second edge plates have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch.
14. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the lower plate is co-planar with the upper plate.
15. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and second edge plates are co-planar.
16. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and second edge plates have different thicknesses.
17. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and second edge plates have identical thicknesses.
18. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate can form an angle of approximately 90 degrees.
19. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate can

form an angle in the range of about 65 to about 85 degrees.

20. The heating table of claim 9, further comprising a support section.

21. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the heating table is capable of finishing the flooring edge with a flooring edge finish as an in-line automated process.
